

Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/kaila-hembrook (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

ServSafe Alcohol Certified
Daily Operations Management
Operations Administration

Certifications

Certified Nursing Assistant
Nonprofit Leadership and Philanthropy
Plain Language

Kaila Hembrook

Associate Director of Development at McCormick School of Engineering
Chicago, Illinois, United States

Summary

Associate Director of Development with the McCormick School of Engineering at Northwestern University where I help guide strategic initiatives to enhance alumni engagement, donor relations and operational efficiency. My main focuses are front-line fundraising for the School of Engineering and collaborating closely with institutional partners and the Dean's Office to align communications and programming that foster meaningful connections with McCormick alumni and supporters.

My journey in philanthropy began at the University of Iowa, where I earned a certificate in nonprofit leadership and philanthropy, held an executive role in a development-focused student organization, and completed two non-profit internships. These experiences shaped my passion for philanthropic work and donor engagement which continues to inspire my current work in higher education development.

Experience

McCormick School of Engineering
1 year 4 months

Associate Director of Development
November 2025 - Present (5 months)
Evanston, Illinois, United States

Assistant Director of Operations
December 2024 - November 2025 (1 year)
Evanston, Illinois, United States

- Innovate and improve team business processes by collaborating with the McCormick School of Engineering partners, aligning initiatives with institutional goals
- Liaise with the Dean's Office to coordinate high-level engagement efforts, enhancing alumni and donor involvement

- Cultivated and strengthened donor relationships as a frontline leadership annual giving fundraiser through visits in-person and virtually
- Strategically partner with alumni engagement teams to expand McCormick alumni programming and streamline communication for appropriate audiences
- Develop communications in line with school priorities, including acknowledgement letter templates, talking points, and case for support documents used by gift officers

Wisconsin Foundation and Alumni Association

2 years 6 months

Assistant Director of Annual Giving, Donor Experience Officer

September 2023 - November 2024 (1 year 3 months)

Madison, Wisconsin, United States

- Discover and cultivate Leadership Annual Giving (LAG) donors using email, phone conversations, in person meetings, and video calls to deepen relationships and qualify for other forms of giving
- Assist in the creation of introduction, solicitation, and stewardship communications to renew and increase annual donor support at the \$250-\$999 and \$1,000-\$24,999 level
- Collaborate with the Marketing and Communications teams to communicate the impact of annual philanthropic support with current and potential donors through video, social media, and digital platforms
- Work alongside campus advancement staff to serve as a point of contact for advancing support of priority areas
- Manage a portfolio of 500 LAG donors between three campus units. (School of Nursing, School of Pharmacy, and the Chancellor's Annual Fund)

Development Program Specialist

June 2022 - September 2023 (1 year 4 months)

Madison, Wisconsin, United States

- Respond to donor and campus questions regarding unit gifts and funds, identifying those inquiries, requests, or issues that require additional review and action
- Help to prepare acknowledgements for the Law and Business School
- Assist Law and School of Business directors of development with the drafting, legal review, signature routing, and final distribution of gift legal documentation (e.g Memoranda of Agreements, Fund Operation Agreements, Pledge Agreements, etc.) in accordance with established WFAA business processes

- Coordinate the stewardship mailing, event invitations, and provide development support for advanced administrative needs when necessary or appropriate (i.e invoice request, printing, project request, event contract handling, etc.)
- Co-Lead a workgroup to encourage discussion and continued learning for fellow Development Program Specialist

Active Minds, Inc.

Development Intern

January 2022 - May 2022 (5 months)

Remote

- Create content for donor letters, fundraising website pages, peer-to-peer fundraising, etc.
- Clean up donor data in Salesforce, Excel Sheets, and Google Documents
- Assist with redesigning Active Minds' Spirit Week toolkit
- Collaborate on projects with Programs and Communications teams

Student Advancement Network

1 year 9 months

Vice President of Communications

August 2021 - May 2022 (10 months)

Iowa City, Iowa, United States

- Assist with various engagement activities to highlight philanthropy efforts on campus
- Advocate for awareness of the UI Center for Advancement and philanthropy among students
- Serve as a student representative to network with university alumni and donors
- Review and recommend Student Impact Grant submissions to the UI Center for Advancement
- Social media manager driving engagement on Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter

Member

September 2020 - August 2021 (1 year)

Iowa City, Iowa, United States

Association of Fundraising Professionals (AFP-Global)

Member

March 2021 - May 2022 (1 year 3 months)

Iowa City, Iowa, United States

- Participate in networking events with nonprofit professionals
- Access learning resources on the AFP Global website
- Raise funds for area nonprofits

Summer of the Arts

Development Intern

September 2021 - December 2021 (4 months)

Iowa City, Iowa, United States

- Compose a weekly newsletter about current events for all organization members
- Carefully compile and monitor information about donors and input into organized excel sheets
- Assist with management of deliverables and marketing for fundraising events
- Assist with development of new fundraising opportunities

Texas Roadhouse

Waitress

August 2020 - September 2021 (1 year 2 months)

Coralville, Iowa, United States

Named the top seller in Iowa my second week after training

Awarded the Server with Heart Award within my first year in the role

Care Initiatives

Certified Nursing Assistant

December 2018 - January 2020 (1 year 2 months)

Knoxville, Iowa

Education

University of Iowa

Communications, Certificate of Nonprofit Leadership and Philanthropy · (August 2019 - May 2022)

Knoxville High School

High School Diploma · (August 2015 - May 2019)